

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience designing, implementing, and managing enterprise security technology stacks across complex, multi-site environments. I bring expert-level proficiency in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR), and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) using CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft Sentinel, and Microsoft Defender. I have deep experience managing email security gateways including Mimecast, enforcing identity and access controls via Microsoft Entra ID and Azure Active Directory (AD), administering endpoint management through Microsoft Intune, and leading Privileged Access Management (PAM) programmes. I am adept at vulnerability management, penetration test remediation, and incident response using the NIST 800-61 framework and MITRE ATT&CK methodology. Holding the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification, I combine strong technical depth with clear communication skills and a track record of delivering measurable security improvements within high-pressure, regulated environments.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM / SOAR:** CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel (KQL, analytics rules, Logic App playbooks, workbooks), alert triage, detection engineering, threat hunting
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Insight, Discover; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE); real-time response, containment, and remediation
- **Email and Web Security:** Mimecast email gateway policy management, threat intelligence integration, web/email security gateway administration
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra ID / Azure AD, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Group Policy
- **Endpoint Management (MDM/MAM):** Microsoft Intune, device compliance policies, application management, endpoint hardening
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM, just-in-time privilege elevation, standing access elimination
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS); scan scheduling, triage, remediation tracking
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK, playbook authoring, senior escalation lead
- **Network Security:** IDS/IPS, WAF, DDoS mitigation, firewall management (Check Point Harmony), security certificate lifecycle management
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, KQL, SOAR automation
- **Frameworks and Standards:** NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+, MITRE ATT&CK, JISC

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer — University of the Arts, London (UAL) *March 2025 – Present*

- Manage and tune CrowdStrike Falcon EDR (Prevent, Insight, Discover) across an 8,000-user estate, including real-time threat detection, alert triage, SIEM/SOAR integration, and endpoint containment actions via Falcon Real Time Response (RTR).
- Administer Mimecast email security gateway, configuring policies, integrating threat intelligence feeds, managing email-borne incident escalation, and reporting on gateway effectiveness to senior stakeholders.
- Design and maintain SIEM detection rules, SOAR playbooks, and EDR response workflows in Microsoft Sentinel, reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) and mean time to respond (MTTR) through automation.
- Manage Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) including Conditional Access policies, MFA enforcement across the user estate, SSO integrations, and identity lifecycle management.

- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) programme, eliminating standing admin rights, enforcing least-privilege access, and managing privileged session recording.
- Manage Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM policies for 8,000+ users, covering device compliance, application deployment, and endpoint security hardening aligned to CIS Controls.
- Oversee IDS/IPS configuration, web security gateway policies, WAF rule management, and network security monitoring, escalating anomalies through the incident response process.
- Lead vulnerability management lifecycle using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera BAS; triage findings, assign severity ratings, track remediation, and report to the Information Security leadership team.
- Remediate penetration testing findings and manage security certificate lifecycle including renewal scheduling, configuration audits, and stakeholder communications.
- Deliver security awareness training programmes and phishing simulation campaigns to build a security-conscious culture across the university.
- Act as senior escalation lead for security incidents, authoring and maintaining response playbooks covering ransomware, phishing, business email compromise (BEC), and credential theft scenarios.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity — University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2022 – March 2025

- Deployed and operationalised CrowdStrike Falcon across the university estate; built and ran a hybrid Security Operations Centre (SOC) integrating CrowdStrike and Microsoft Sentinel.
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender to deliver integrated Extended Detection and Response (XDR) coverage.
- Designed Microsoft Sentinel workspace architecture including data connector configuration, analytics rule authoring using Kusto Query Language (KQL), Logic App playbook automation, and workbook dashboards.
- Managed daily SIEM/SOAR alert triage, threat hunting across endpoint, identity, email, and cloud telemetry, and coordinated incident response actions in line with NIST 800-61.
- Administered Mimecast, Check Point Harmony firewall, and Tanium for endpoint visibility and patch management across a complex, distributed environment.
- Supported vulnerability assessment programmes using Nessus and AppCheck, triaging findings and coordinating remediation with IT infrastructure teams.
- Contributed to Cyber Essentials Plus certification, ISO 27001 gap assessments, and NIST CSF maturity reviews.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure — HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/ FinTech)

February 2021 – March 2022

- Managed corporate IT security controls, endpoint management (Intune/MDM), and identity services (Azure AD, MFA) for a cloud-first SaaS organisation.
- Implemented security hardening measures across Microsoft 365 and Azure environments, reducing attack surface and improving compliance posture.
- Administered network security including firewall rules, VPN access controls, and endpoint protection configuration.
- Conducted security risk assessments, supported internal audits, and developed IT security policies aligned to ISO 27001 and CIS Controls.
- Managed IT infrastructure quality assurance, supporting DevOps teams with secure configuration baselines and access control governance.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon across an 8,000-user estate and built a hybrid SOC, improving threat detection coverage and reducing dwell time significantly.
- Designed and implemented Microsoft Sentinel SIEM workspace from the ground up, including 50+ analytics rules, automated playbooks, and executive workbook dashboards.
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across 8,000 users, delivering integrated XDR capability.
- Implemented BeyondTrust PAM programme, eliminating all standing administrative access and achieving zero-standing-privilege posture for privileged accounts.

- Led Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) exercises, identifying and remediating critical gaps in detection and prevention controls.
- Contributed to achieving Cyber Essentials Plus certification and progressed ISO 27001 alignment programme across the organisation.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP 75,000 – 90,000 | Hybrid (London/UK)